

The Android version of the new Kodi release is standards-compliant with the platform's official audio API. It works with devices that are running on at least Android 5.0 (Lollipop). The release also has DTS-HD, DTS-X, Dolby TrueHD and Dolby Atmos pass through support for devices with AudioTrack v23 or newer.

The Kodi software has built-in support for 4K video and output as well as HEVC, VC-1/WMV 9 and VP9 playback on compatible hardware. You can make all the changes within the latest version of Kodi from its official changelog page. Also, the merged pull requests on the open source project are available from the official GitHub repository.

Interestingly, despite being a highly acclaimed project by the open source community, the latest Kodi is the first release to reach the Windows Store for downloads. The software is wrapped in a UWP (Universal Windows Platform) to enable easy installation on Windows 10. It also supports Windows 7 and 8 hardware.

Canonical patches Ubuntu vulnerabilities through new updates

Canonical has released some new kernel updates to fix vulnerabilities within its Ubuntu platform. The versions that are affected by the security issues include Ubuntu 12.04 LTS, 14.04 LTS, 16.04 LTS and 16.10.



Through six distinct security notices on its website, Canonical revealed the vulnerabilities. The company confirmed that the security holes exist across many Ubuntu flavours such as Kubuntu, Xubuntu and Ubuntu MATE, in addition to the original Ubuntu versions.

Ubuntu 12.04 LTS and 14.04 LTS include the security flaw CVE-2016-9555, which is within Linux kernel's SCTP implementation and leads to the platform improperly handling the validation of incoming data, which could result in a denial of service (DoS) attack. The Ubuntu 12.04 LTS build also includes multiple memory leaks within the XFS file system support.

In Ubuntu 16.04 LTS and Ubuntu 16.10, the Canonical team has found two major security issues. The first vulnerability, documented as CVE-2016-10147, is hidden in the asynchronous multi-buffer cryptographic daemon of the Linux kernel. It allows attackers to crash the system via a DoS attack.

CVE-2016-8399, the second issue, is in the Linux kernel's Internet Control Message Protocol (ICMP) implementation. It gives CAP_NET_ADMIN privileges to local attackers to expose sensitive information.

Ubuntu 16.10 also includes the vulnerabilities CVE-2016-10150, CVE-2016-8632 and CVE-2016-9777. These loopholes can either result in a DoS attack to Ubuntu systems, the system crashing or attackers gaining administrative privileges within the host operating system. You can install the latest Ubuntu updates to patch the reported vulnerabilities. Once installed, make sure to reboot your system.

Mirantis containerises OpenContrail within OpenStack ecosystem

Active OpenStack contributor, Mirantis, has containerised OpenContrail. Containerising and supporting OpenContrail will help the California-based company grow into a 'one-stop support shop' for all popular open source technologies used with OpenStack.

OpenContrail is a widely used SDN platform that simplifies OpenStack cloud management for administrators. The rate at which software-defined networking is evolving, administrators may soon have to develop skillsets specifically for OpenContrail. The platform works as an extensible system for cloud networking and network function virtualisation. This would help Mirantis grow its presence in the OpenStack world.

GIMP 2.8.20 brings out several fixes to Linux, iOS and Windows

The GIMP, the popular open source image viewer and editor, has published a new stable release. The GIMP 2.8.20 build has various improvements and bug fixes for all supported platforms, including Linux, iOS and Windows.

The new GIMP has enhanced the toggling of colour picker mode in the paint tools. On iOS devices, the image editing tool now prompts users to select the preferred language during the first time it's being set up. Its Windows version, on the other hand, has fixed the annoying oscillating switching between input devices. The update also works well on Windows-powered tablets.



In addition to the platform-based changes, the new GIMP version comes with quite a few improvements. There is an improved saving feature for existing *.xcf.gz* and *.xcf.bz* files. Slider handles that were almost not visible while using dark themes have been also fixed. Besides, the updated version has improved stylus tablet support to enhance the image editing experience on tablets.

The GIMP comes pre-installed with various Linux distributions. However, if you are using an iOS or Windows device, you need to manually install it. The update includes an improved installer for Windows and iOS to deliver a faster experience on proprietary platforms.

You can download the GIMP 2.8.20 build from its official download page. The new build comes after six-and-a-half months.